



OPPOSITION ANALYSIS

FEYENOORD

A controlled, left-loading possession side that overwhelms you with volume and finishes ruthlessly — but is rarely a counter-attacker itself, and concedes its clearest chances when its build-up is pressed and turned over.

SCOUTING WINDOW

Eredivisie 2022/23 · matchdays 1–10 · 10 matches (7 Aug – 16 Oct 2022)

Source: Opta F24 event data + F7 line-ups · every metric computed from raw event feeds



PREPARED BY

Mats van Eijk



7-2-1	26-11	58%	18.7	1.83	27	9.7	1.21
W-D-L	GOALS	POSSESSION	SHOTS/GAME	XG/GAME	GOALS (18.3 xG)	SHOTS CONCEDED/G	XGA/GAME

FIVE THINGS THAT DECIDE THE GAME

1 · Make it a transition game — they won't

They keep 58% of the ball but took just ONE fast-break shot in 10 games: a control side, not a counter side. A passing contest suits them; repeated transitions do not.

3 · Their damage comes through the LEFT

41% of final-third entries and 58% of crosses come down their left (Hancko & López build, Idrissi isolates, Szymański drifts in). Overload your defensive right side.

5 · Set pieces are live both ways

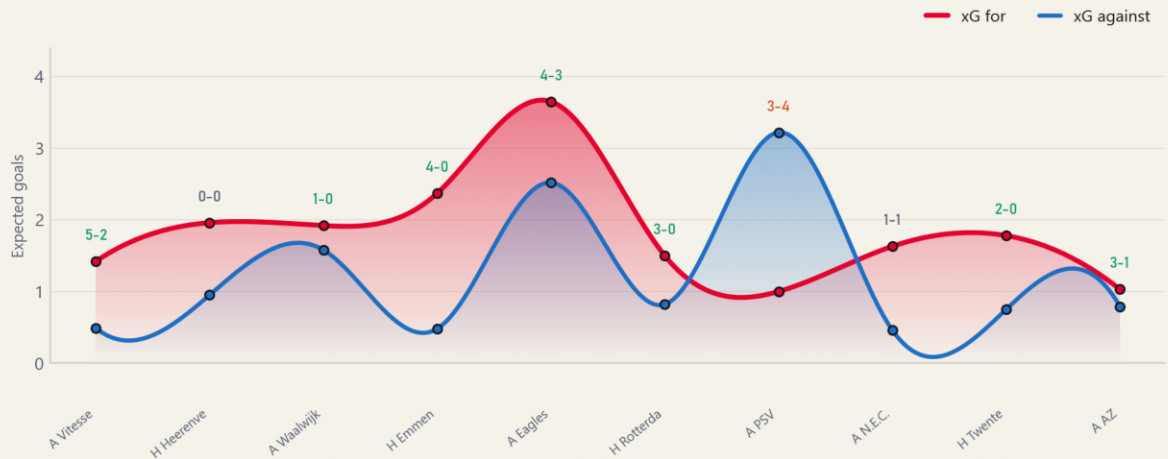
5 set-piece goals scored, 3 conceded. Corners come mostly from the left to the far post (48 of 75) — a moment to defend with numbers and to attack as a real route to goal.

2 · Press their build-up — that's where they crack

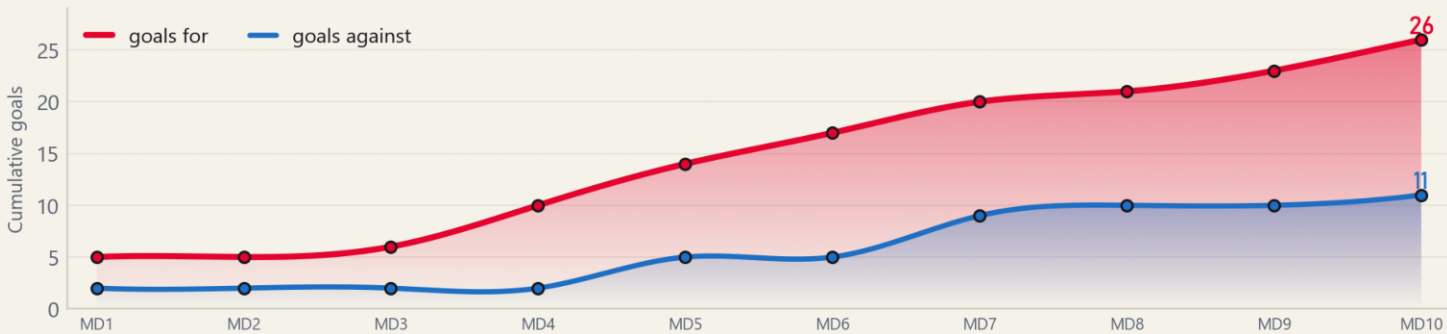
29% of the shots they concede (3.9 xGA) come within 15s of a Feyenoord turnover, and those losses sit in their own half (avg x=32). Win it high and you get a clear look.

4 · Strike early — they own the late game

Their one window where xGA beats xG is 15–30' (2.9 xGA, 4 conceded). After 60' they scored 12 and conceded 1. Land the first blow; don't bank on chasing them late.



Expected goals, match by match



KEY INSIGHT

They control games and out-create everyone — beat them only in open, transitional matches.

- ▶ xG sits above xGA in 8 of 10 games — a passing contest favours them.
- ▶ The only cracks: PSV (3.22 xGA, lost) and Go Ahead (2.52) — both open and end-to-end.
- ▶ Two shapes (4-2-3-1 / 4-3-3), one constant: Kökcü as the deepest pivot.

7-2-1

W-D-L

1.83

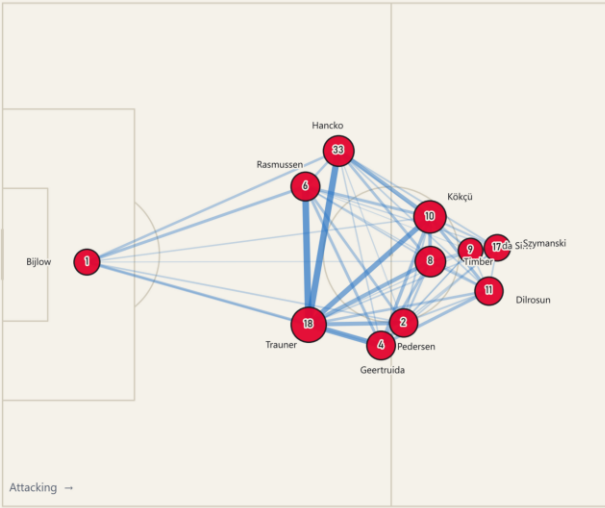
XG/GAME

26-11

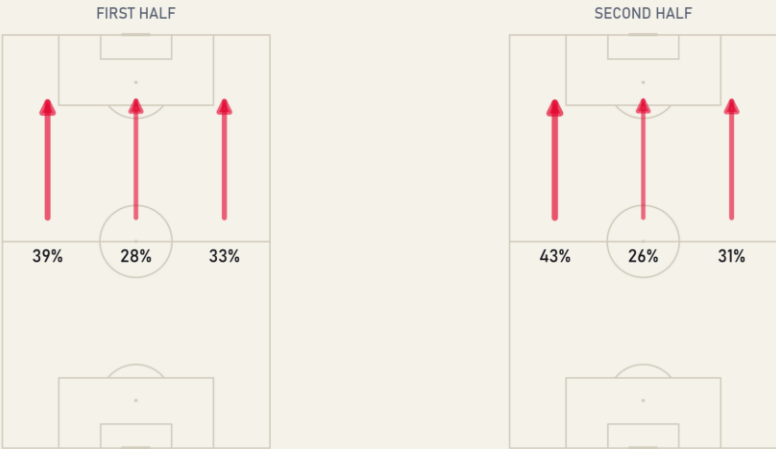
GOALS

1.21

XGA/GAME



Average positions (build-up shape) · 1

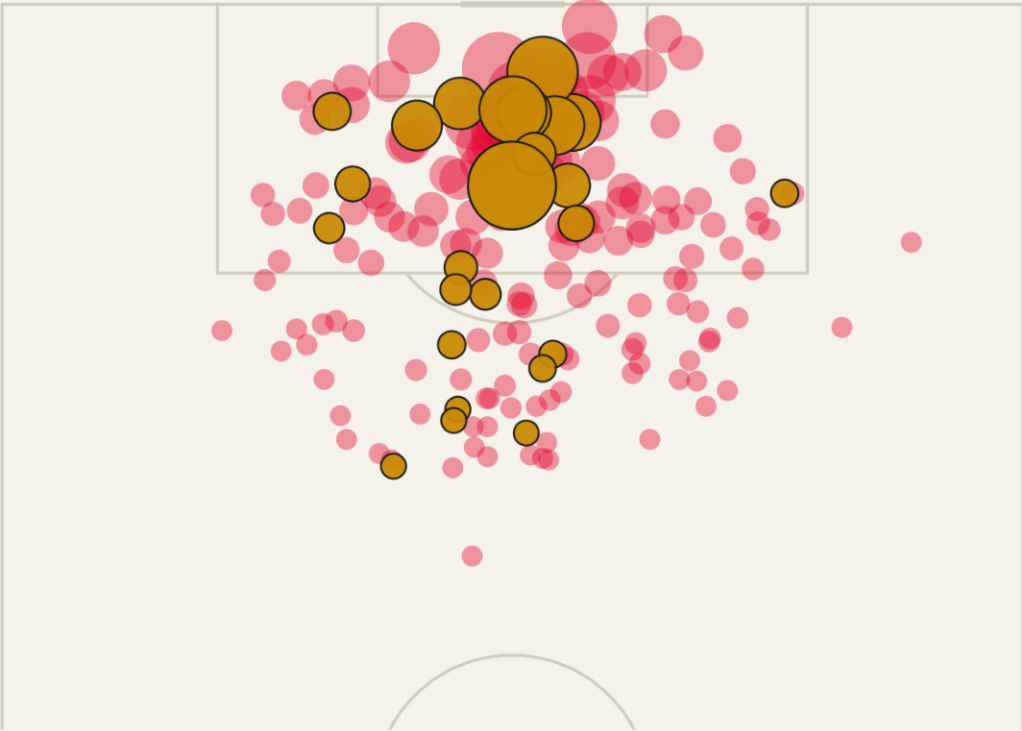


KEY INSIGHT

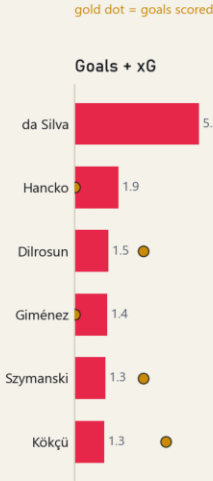
They play through you and load the LEFT — cut Kökçü's time and crowd that channel.

- ▶ Only 10% long balls — patient build via Trauner/Hancko, Kökçü dropping in.
- ▶ 41% of final-third entries and 58% of crosses come down the left.
- ▶ 18.9 crosses/game but just 25% completed — defend the box and live with it.

58%	22.1
POSSESSION	PROG PASSES/G
18.9	25%
CROSSES/G	CROSSES DONE

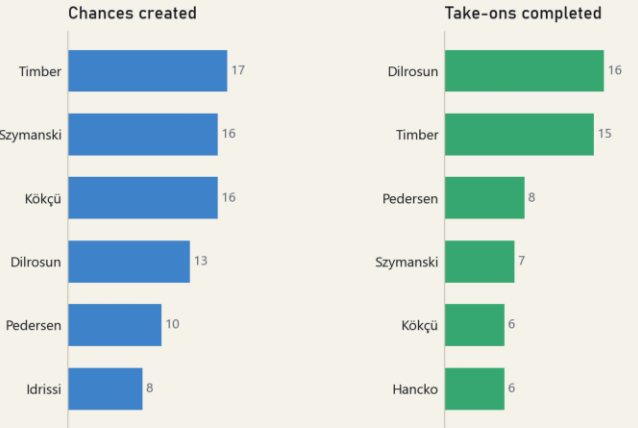


Every shot · size = xG · gold = goals

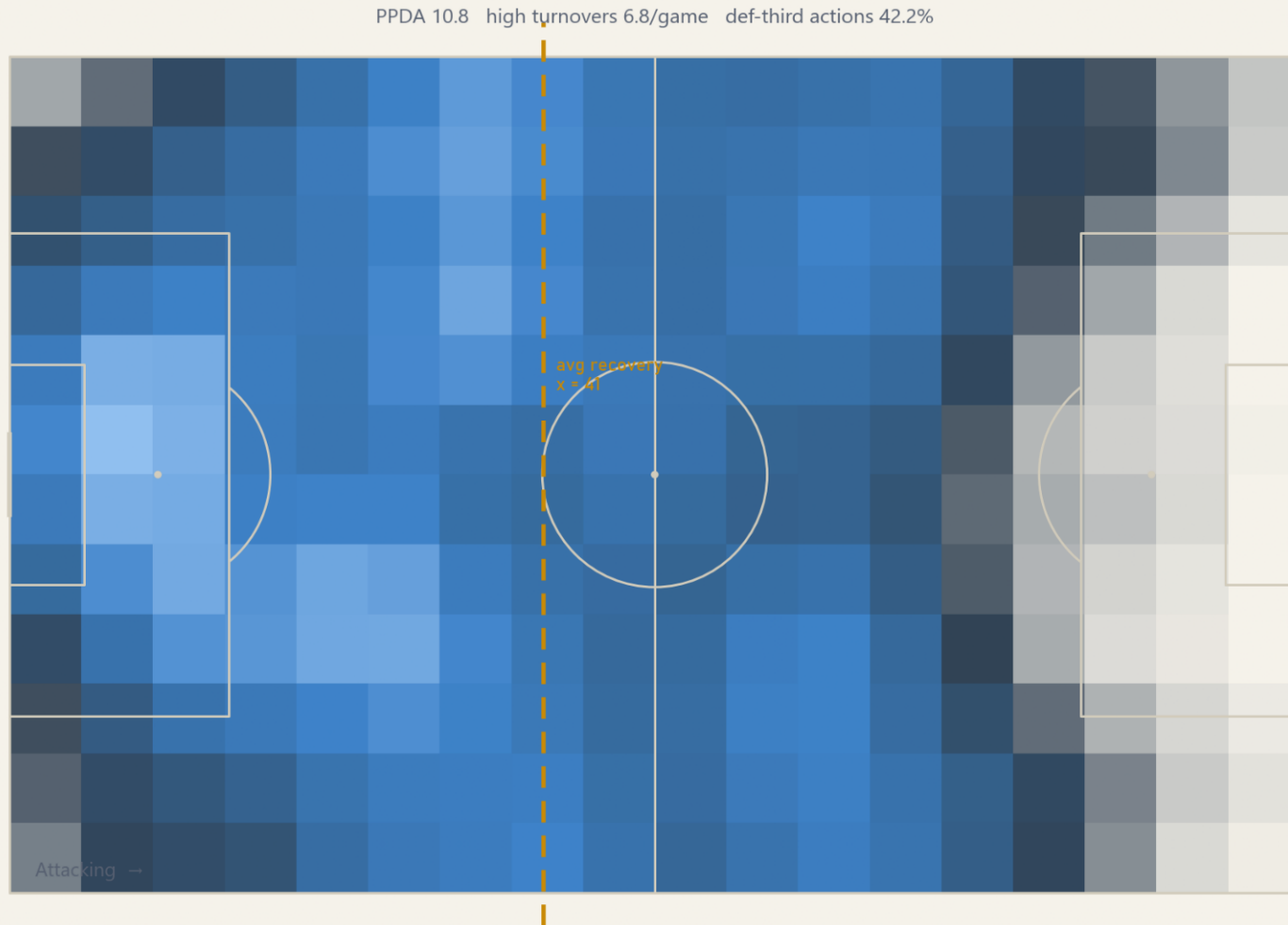


KEY INSIGHT

Manufactured central chances and clinical finishing — deny the cutback and the half-space.



187	27
SHOTS	GOALS
18.3	28
XG	BIG CHANCES



Defensive actions heat · gold line = avg recovery height

KEY INSIGHT

They invite you in and counter — slow build lets them re-set, so play vertical and fast.

- ▶ PPDA 10.8, only 14.5% of defensive actions in the attacking third.
- ▶ Recoveries average around halfway — controlled, not frantic.
- ▶ We WILL get the ball in our half; the question is how quickly we use it.

10.8

PPDA

x41

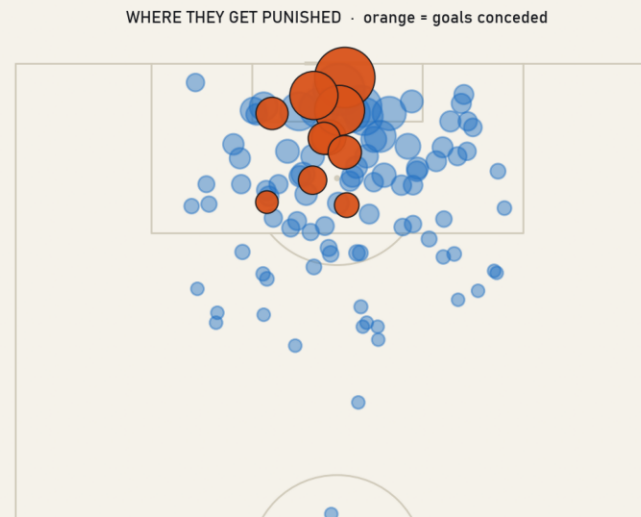
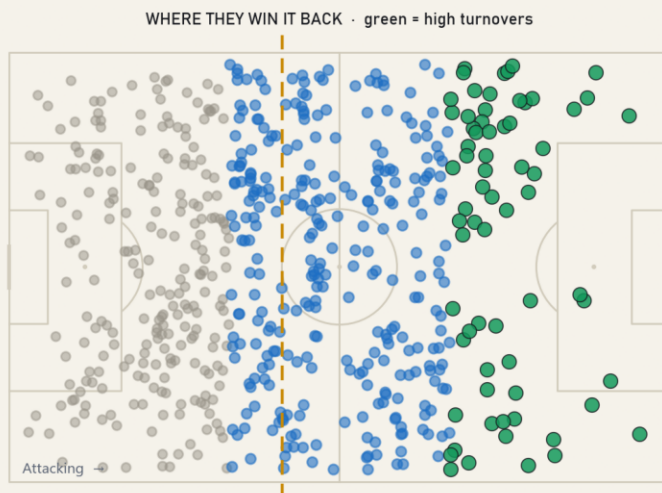
AVG RECOVERY

42%

ACTIONS DEF THIRD

6.8

HIGH TURNOVERS/G



Left: where they regain · Right: where they get punished

KEY INSIGHT

Their high line and committed full-backs are the door — win it and go, fast, in behind.

- ▶ They concede a higher xG PER SHOT than they create (0.124 vs 0.098).
- ▶ 72% of shots conceded are inside the box — almost all on transition.
- ▶ PSV (3.22 xGA) and Go Ahead (2.52) exploited exactly this.

0.124

XGA/SHOT

72%

CONCEDED IN BOX

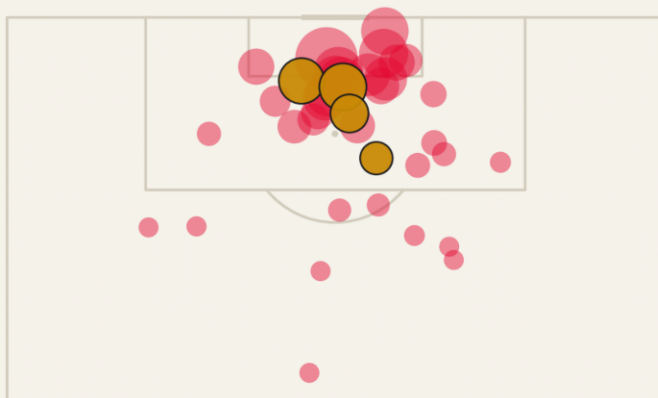
68

HIGH RECOVERIES

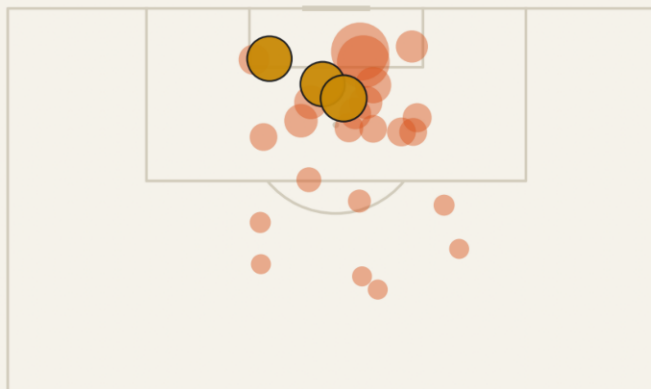
10

GOALS CONCEDED

THREAT • 39 shots / 5 goals / 5.8 xG



CONCEDED • 26 shots / 3 goals / 3.1 xG



Set-piece shots — threat (left) and conceded (right)

KEY INSIGHT

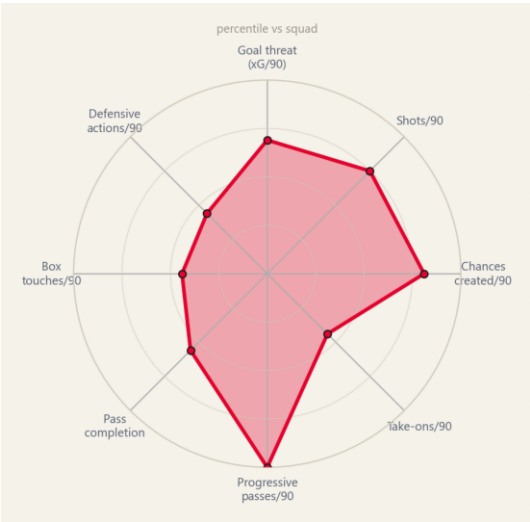
A genuine route to goal for us — and a moment we must defend with full numbers.

- ▶ ~1 in 5 of their shots is from a set piece (39 shots, 5 goals, 5.8 xG).
- ▶ Trauner and Hancko attack the box; Kökçü delivers.
- ▶ But they conceded 3 set-piece goals in 10 games — load the box, far post.

5	3
SP GOALS FOR	SP GOALS AGAINST
39	26
SP SHOTS FOR	SP SHOTS AGAINST

Orkun Kökçü

10 · Deep pivot

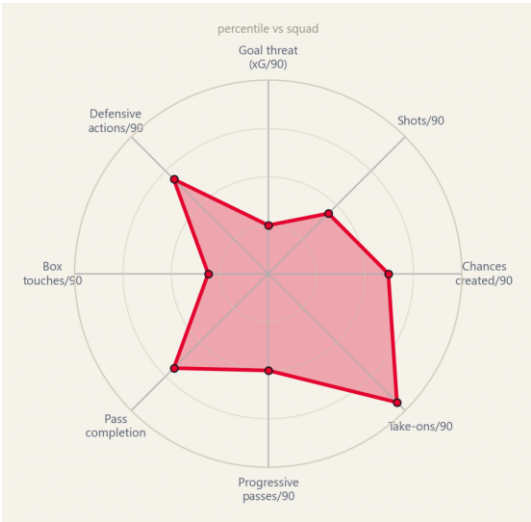


The hub: 888 touches, team-high 39 progressive passes, 16 chances created, 4 goals, plus penalties and corners. Receives around halfway, left-centre. DENY THE TURN — screen the pass back to him and stop him facing our goal.

688 mins in window

Quinten Timber

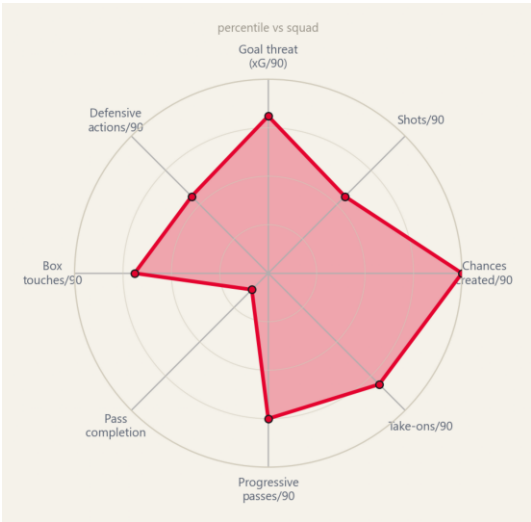
8 · Box-to-box



Best 1v1 in the side (27 take-ons, 56% won) and team-high 17 chances created from deep, 924 minutes. Arrives in the box (26 box touches). Track his forward runs — he turns control into penetration.

924 mins in window

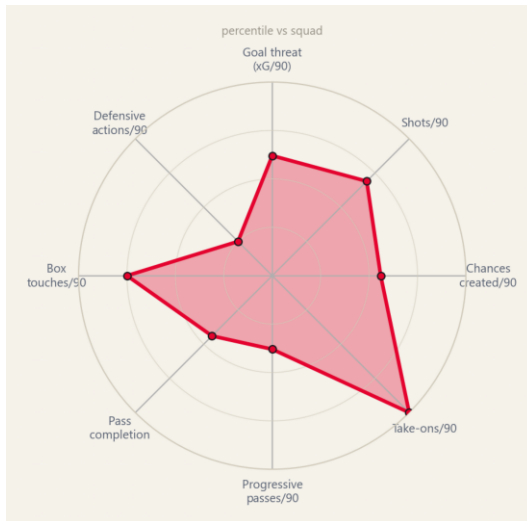
Sebastian Szymanski



558 mins in window

Javairô Dilrosun

11 · Roaming forward

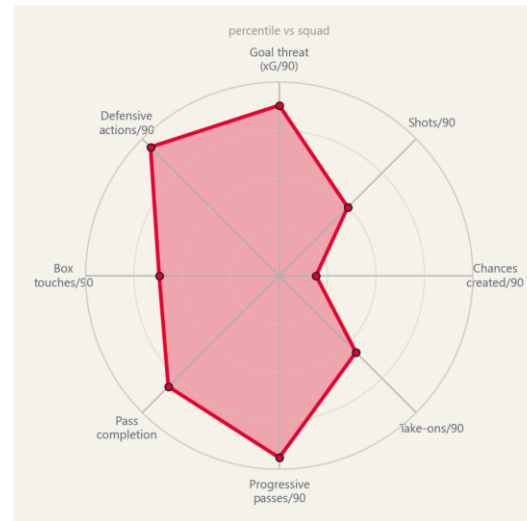


High-volume dribbler — 46 take-ons but only 35% won, roaming central/right (y=43), team-high 49 box touches, 3 goals. Containable: show him inside, deny the box entry rather than dive in.

813 mins in window

Dávid Hancko

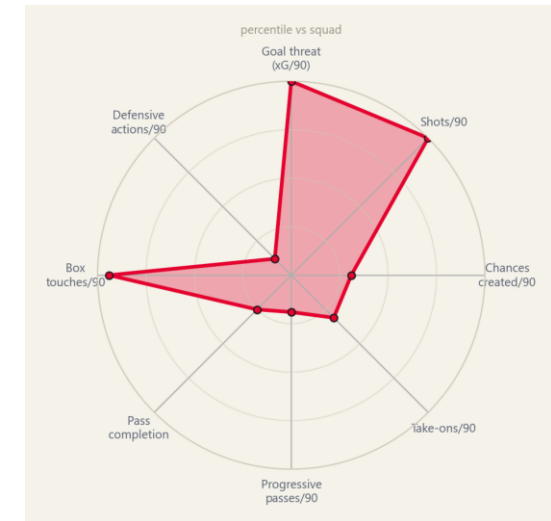
33 · Left centre-back



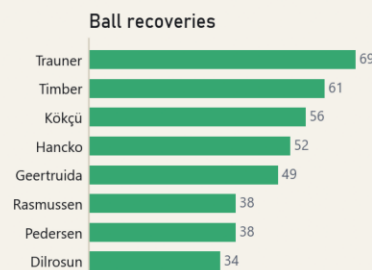
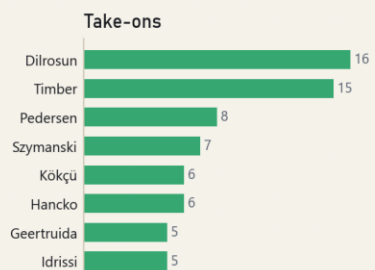
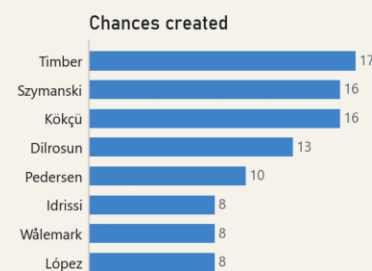
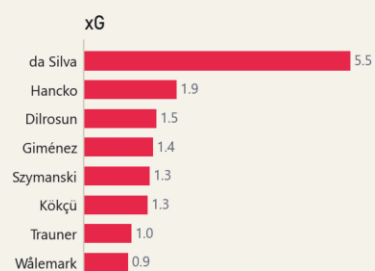
Engine of the left build-up: #2 progressive passer, 1.9 xG from set pieces, 958 minutes. He steps into midfield — and the channel he vacates is exactly the space to attack in transition.

614 mins in window

Danilo Pereira da Silva



597 mins in window



KEY INSIGHT

Threat is shared, but the creative load runs through a small core.

- ▶ Kökçü & Hancko drive progression; Timber & Szymański create.
- ▶ Dilrosun is the dribble threat; Danilo the focal finisher.
- ▶ Depth is real — Giménez, Wälemark, Idrissi all contribute off the bench.



WITH THE BALL

- ▶ Win-it-and-go from their HALF: the moment we turn them over in their build-up, attack — 29% of the shots they concede start exactly here.
- ▶ Front-load the threat: target the 15–30' window (their only negative-xG period) and don't plan to chase them after 60', when they are ruthless.
- ▶ When set, attack the space behind Hancko's steps with a runner from our right.
- ▶ Treat set pieces as a primary route to goal — they concede from them; rehearse far-post and second-phase routines.

WITHOUT THE BALL

- ▶ Press the build-up with triggers: jump when it goes back to Trauner/Bijlow or square to the left-back; screen the lane into Kőkü so he can't turn.
- ▶ Force them to cross from deep down their left, then defend the box with numbers — win first AND second contact (only 25% of crosses land).
- ▶ No isolated 1v1s for our right-back vs the left overload; the winger tracks the high left-back.
- ▶ Control our line in a mid-block; they barely counter (1 fast-break shot), so the risk is sustained pressure, not balls in behind — stay compact and patient.

IN-GAME SCENARIOS

If they line up 4-3-3

Their sharper, more left-loaded shape (2.07 xG, 43% left). Double the left side, and use a spare man to jump Kőkü; they press less here (PPDA 12.2) so we can build.

If we lead

Stay in the block, manage set pieces, keep press triggers on their build-up; don't drop so deep we invite the sustained pressure they thrive on.

If they line up 4-2-3-1

Leakier (1.34 xGA) and they press higher (PPDA 9.7) — more space in behind. Bait the press and release runners early into the channels.

First 30' / after a goal

Their soft window is 15–30'. Start fast and physical, take an early lead — the late game (60'+: 12 goals, 1 conceded) belongs to them.



How I would feed this into the week — the right information, to the right people, in the right format, at the right time. Players get less, sharper and more visual as the match nears; never more than three messages a day on the pitch.

MD-4

Staff alignment

Full dossier to the head coach and assistants. Agree the game-model response: press triggers on their build-up, block height, set-piece plans, the early-game intent. Lock the 3-4 headline messages we will drip to players. No player video yet — align the staff story first.

MD-3

Team — out of possession

Squad meeting (8-10 min). One theme: how they build and where they crack. Clip reel — Kökçü dropping, the left overload, turnovers that became shots. The ask: 'press the build-up, screen Kökçü, force them left, win the box.' Back line + keeper unit on the in-behind picture.

MD-2

Team — in possession & transition

Our route to goal: clips of turnovers in their half and the space behind Hancko's steps; train transition-to-finish drills mirroring their shape. Wingers/full-backs get a clip pack on their direct opponent (Idrissi, the high left-back, Pedersen).

MD-1

Set pieces & individuals

Set-piece meeting both ways: our far-post marking vs Trauner/Hancko; our attacking routines vs their box defence. Hand out individual clips (60-90s) to the players who need them — personal, on their direct duel. Keep it light and confident.

MD

Reminders only

No new information. A one-page visual in the dressing room: the 3 keys (press their build-up / force left & win the box / strike early). 30-second individual reminders. Live: flag from the bench whether they're in 4-3-3 or 4-2-3-1 and adjust per the plan.



THEIR THREAT

- ▶ Left-loading possession side (58% ball, 18.7 shots/g)
- ▶ Build through Kökçü; left overload (41% entries, 58% crosses)
- ▶ Clinical: 27 goals from 18.3 xG · 28 big chances
- ▶ Set-piece danger: 5 SP goals (Trauner, Hancko)

THEIR WEAKNESS

- ▶ Concede few but HIGH-quality chances (0.124 xGA/shot)
- ▶ 72% of shots conceded inside the box — on transition
- ▶ High line + committed full-backs = space in behind
- ▶ 3 set-piece goals conceded in 10 games

OUR PLAN

- ▶ Win-it-and-go: attack in behind the full-backs FAST
- ▶ Make it transitional, not a possession contest
- ▶ Compact block, screen Kökçü, force them to cross from deep
- ▶ Win the box both ends — set pieces are our route

THE 3 KEYS

1 · FORCE THEM LEFT & DEFEND THE BOX 2 · WIN-IT-AND-GO IN BEHIND 3 · WIN SET PIECES BOTH ENDS



HOW THIS WAS BUILT

Every figure and number is computed directly from the raw Opta F24 event feeds and F7 line-ups for Feyenoord's first ten Eredivisie 2022/23 matches — no third-party aggregations. The pitch convention is stated and verified: $y > 66.7$ is the attacking LEFT (cross-checked against known left- and right-sided players). Expected goals (xG) uses a transparent distance-and-angle geometry model with header and set-piece adjustments, calibrated so the mean across all shots in the sample matches a league-typical ~ 0.11 ; Feyenoord's own shots average 0.098 — high volume at slightly below-average quality. Goal totals are quoted as match results (26 for, 11 against); the shot-event feed attributes 27/10, the small difference being own goals. Transition chances link each opponent shot to the Feyenoord ball-loss within 15 seconds before it.

WHAT I'D ADD WITH MORE TIME / DATA

- ▶ Tracking & possession data to quantify pressing triggers and line height.
- ▶ Full-season sample to separate stable patterns from noise.
- ▶ Linked Sportscode clips for every figure — one click to the moment.
- ▶ Opponent-specific set-piece pack, frame by frame.

KEY CLIPS TO PULL

Goals conceded — the transition template

A Vitesse	18:58	Manhoef · open play
A Vitesse	55:05	Frederiksen · open play
A Go Ahead Eagles	12:51	Lidberg · open play
A Go Ahead Eagles	95:13	Edvardsen · open play
A PSV	15:46	Branthwaite · set piece
A PSV	24:47	Gakpo · open play
A PSV	46:15	Til · open play
A PSV	82:39	Obispo · set piece

Their goals — patterns to defend

A Vitesse	30:26	Wålemark · open play
A Vitesse	40:18	da Silva · set piece
A Vitesse	60:06	Dilrosun · open play
A Vitesse	65:03	da Silva · open play
A Vitesse	68:22	Geertruida · open play
A RKC Waalwijk	67:55	da Silva · open play
H FC Emmen	59:21	Timber · open play
H FC Emmen	84:13	Giménez · open play